2015). It raised concerns over unofficial election campaigns and party promises, especially from the ruling party. For example, the minister for industry distributed gifts in fifteen villages in Min Kin township to get people to vote for the USDP (Ye Mon and Wa Lone 2015).

The largest number of complaints arose over the voter lists. Although the UEC disseminated preliminary voter lists across the country and invited people to correct mistakes for fourteen days starting on 7 September 2015, few people checked the lists, and errors were only made known later. In the end, the UEC released preliminary voter lists four times, but a correct listing could not be compiled as political parties criticized the process and did not cooperate in getting people to check their details.

Voting rights for people who lived in slum areas also became a significant unresolved issue. Legally, people living as squatters and in slums are not eligible to register as residents of a constituency, since they have no definite address and no official household registration in a town or ward. This made it impossible for the UEC to register these people. Furthermore, the commission also had to be aware that a big movement of people into slums around Yangon area could significantly affect election outcomes. This happened in 2010, particularly in South Okkalapa constituency, where a large number of fishermen from Ayeyarwady Region deliberately moved into the constituency and voted as migrant workers in Yangon Region. Nevertheless, the UEC did agree to relax its rules for migrant workers to vote in their current constituencies, even though formally they should not have been able to do so (Eleven Myanmar 2015). However, political parties continuously emphasized the voting rights of those in slums; they pointed out that citizens' right to vote was at odds with the law.

Despite all the speculation, accusations, and rumours just before the election, the real essence of holding an election through public participation could be observed on election day, 8 November 2015. Long queues waited outside ballot stations at dawn. The enthuastic and disciplined participation of the public showed how Myanmar could hold free, fair, and transparent general elections for the first time in decades. As the vote counting went on, nearly all election observers, both local and international, clearly stated that the election was overall fairly free and transparent. This successful achievement was the result of the politically active Myanmar community, and the relentless efforts of the UEC, political parties, and a handful of CSOs as well as international groups that came to Myanmar before and during the process to communicate their skills and offer their experience.